

Profile

Personal information

Name Odhiambo, Tony Rotich
Share different name No
Birthdate 07/23/2006

Contact details

Email, Phone tonyrotich2580@gmail.com, +254.713466762, Mobile, No other telephone
Permanent address Miami Close, 25 Nairobi, KEN

Demographics

Gender Identity Male
Sex Male
Pronouns He/Him
Military status None

Language

English First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home
Swahili First Language, Speak, Read, Write, Spoken at Home

Geography and nationality

Citizenship status Citizen of non-U.S. country
Birthplace Kiambu, Kenya 0 years US
Other citizenships Kenya
Current US Visa None
Intended US Visa I do not know which visa I will hold

Common App fee waiver

Fee waiver requested Yes, Signed: Tony Rotich Odhiambo

PREVIEW

Family

Household

Parents	Married
Home	Both Parents

Parent 1

Mother

Name	Mrs. Jebet C Odhiambo (Chebii)
Email, Phone	jebetchesiyna@gmail.com, +254.722739211, Mobile
Occupation	Other, Human Resources Professional, Employed, Best Harvest
Education	Graduated from college/university Business (2012), Moi University, P. O. Box 3900 - 30100, Kesses, Eldoret, Kenya, Eldoret, Rift Valley, Kenya Bachelors (2001), Strathmore University, Karen Ole Sangale Rd, off Langata Road, Madaraka Estate, Nairobi, Kenya

Parent 2

Father

Name	Mr. Christopher O Mak'Anyango
Email, Phone	chris_kale@yahoo.com, +254.706547077, Mobile
Occupation	Farmer or rancher, Self-Employed
Education	Graduated from college/university Other (1994), Computech Institute, Afya Centre, Tom Mboya St, Nairobi, Nairobi, Kenya

Siblings

Arnold Odhiambo, Age 20
Sharon Odhiambo, Age 11
Abigail Odhiambo, Age 1

Education

Current or most recent secondary school

Light Academy Boys Nairobi, Nairobi, Kenya, Independent (01/2020 - 11/2023)

Boarding school	Yes: Living at school
Progression	No change in progression
Graduation Date	11/2023

Colleges & universities

Grades

Rank	1 / 142, Unweighted
GPA	11.98 / 12, Unweighted

Current or most recent year courses

First trimester

MATH - Mathematics - (REG)
ENG - English - (REG)
LANG - Kiswahili - (REG)
BIOL - Biology - (REG)
CHEM - Chemistry - (REG)
PHYS - Physics - (REG)
OTH/ELE - Geography - (REG)
OTH/ELE - Business Studies - (REG)

Second trimester

MATH - Mathematics - (REG)
ENG - English - (REG)
LANG - Kiswahili - (REG)
BIOL - Biology - (REG)
CHEM - Chemistry - (REG)
PHYS - Physics - (REG)
OTH/ELE - Geography - (REG)
OTH/ELE - Business Studies - (REG)

Third trimester

MATH - Mathematics - (REG)
ENG - English - (REG)
LANG - Kiswahili - (REG)
BIOL - Biology - (REG)
CHEM - Chemistry - (REG)
PHYS - Physics - (REG)
OTH/ELE - Geography - (REG)
OTH/ELE - Business Studies - (REG)

Honors

Pan African Math Olympiad Silver medal, competing against 33 countries	International	12
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East African Mathematical Olympiad Gold Medal	International	12
Rise for the World Global Finalist	International	11, 12
Silver Honour & National Award, International Astronomy and Astrophysics Competition	International	10, 11
Young Scientists Kenya National Finalist	National	11

Community-based organizations

CBO 1	Yale Young African Scholars
Counselor	Ms. Angie Epifano
Email, Phone	angie.epifano@yale.edu

Future plans

Scientific researcher, Doctorate

Testing

SAT tests

Evidence-based Reading and Writing	740	08/26/2023
Math	800	08/26/2023
Taken	1	
Planned	0	
SAT Essay	No	

AP Subject Tests

Calculus BC	5	05/2023
Physics C Mechanics	4	05/2023

Leaving Exams

Mathematics	A	11/2023, Predicted, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
English	A	11/2023, Predicted, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Kiswahili	A	11/2023, Predicted, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Biology	A	11/2023, Predicted, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Chemistry	A	11/2023, Predicted, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Physics	A	11/2023, Predicted, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Geography	A	11/2023, Predicted, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)
Business Studies	A	11/2023, Predicted, Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE)

Activities

Science/Math

11, 12
School
5 hr/wk, 6 wk/yr
Continue

Kenyan Representative in International Olympiads, Kenya Mathematical Olympiad

I represented Kenya in global mathematical Olympiads online, in Rwanda and Japan, and won a gold and a silver medal, being one of the top in Africa

Research

10, 11
Year
7 hr/wk, 25 wk/yr
Continue

Climate Researcher, Young Scientists Kenya National Competition

Researched air pollution management & energy production, made a detailed proposal for sustainable electricity generation. Recognized by USA ambassador

Science/Math

10, 11, 12
School
3 hr/wk, 20 wk/yr
Continue

Club President, Light Academy Mathematics Club

Revitalized the math club, and increased membership from 15 to 35. Tutored members of the school math team for the national Olympiad, 4 were finalists

Other Club/Activity

10, 11
School
4 hr/wk, 30 wk/yr
Continue

Vice Captain, Light Academy Chess Club

Trained members, organized tournaments, doubled membership, won 2 bronze & 1 gold medal in the national championship(2022), the club having 8 finalists

Athletics: Club

10, 11
School
10 hr/wk, 26 wk/yr

Volleyball, Volleyball Captain, Light Academy Volleyball Team

Played as lead setter on the school team. Led the team to win 2 tournaments, organized training sessions & held off-the-court team-building activities

Academic

12
Break
84 hr/wk, 1 wk/yr
Continue

Residential Scholar, Yale Young African Scholars (YYAS)
One of 48 (2000 applicants) accepted to selective academic & university prep program in Zimbabwe, attended leadership summit, received mentorship

Science/Math

12
Break
8 hr/wk, 3 wk/yr

Founder & Instructor, MathINK Problem Solving Initiative
Curated a course to teach high school students about olympiad and real-life problem-solving, encouraged an interest in science, exploration & discovery

Community Service (Volunteer)

12
Break
3 hr/wk, 4 wk/yr
Continue

Alumni Volunteer, Young Scientists Kenya
Participated in STEM outreach events, showcased various experiments to public high school students, answered inquiries about science & research

Religious

10, 11
Break
7 hr/wk, 7 wk/yr
Continue

Preacher, Bible Study Coordinator, ACK Holy Trinity Church Kitengela
Preached in the Youth Church, Held Wednesday Bible study sessions, discussed various topics about the Christian Faith, Organized church cleanup efforts

Debate/Speech

11
School
4 hr/wk, 8 wk/yr
Continue

Debate and MUN Club Coordinator, Debate and Model United Nations
Coordinated the writing and refining of resolutions, acted as team leader during debate tournaments, our team won M-Pesa Regional Debate Tournament

Writing

Personal essay

Some students have a background, identity, interest, or talent that is so meaningful they believe their application would be incomplete without it. If this sounds like you, then please share your story.

The sun's rays pierced through the acacia and baobab trees alike. A slow wind could be felt, making us shiver in the broad grasslands. Chirping birds, mooing cows, and bleating goats could be heard all around us. This was Kajiado, where I could call home. Moreover, no day would be complete without a trip to the river to fetch water during the drought.

As me and my friend Joshua walked, we created intriguing puzzles for our amusement - our unique form of fun. Whoever failed to answer the riddle was shamed by the cows in the vicinity. Don't ask me how! Understand that a fourteen-year-old's mind was one of make-believe.

That evening, Joshua posed a question even he couldn't answer.

"Tony, let's imagine a game. Here is a pile of 40 stones. The game is played in turns. With each turn, a player can pick one, two, three, or four stones and put them in this bucket. The winner is the one who puts the last stone into the bucket. Should you go first or second to have higher winning chances?"

I was stupefied. There were so many possibilities for how the game could progress. How would I find the winning strategy in the myriad of possibilities?

This was not my first encounter with games. At school, I won a prestigious scholarship enabling me to access the limitless possibilities of technology, and within, video games. It was an entirely new world, offering an outlet to unwind from academic activities and have fun.

One such game was a rigged puzzle video game. The CPU mastermind opponent in the game was known simply as Greg. In short, there was no chance of the player winning, no matter how adept they were. Greg was invincible. Over time, I sought to learn from Greg, what makes him unbeatable, and how to translate these skills into my life.

I decided to picture myself playing the stone game with Greg. In my imagination, Greg let me go first, and I was elated. I had a little suspicion that going first would enable me to win because I could indirectly force Greg to make particular moves. However, my chess intuition wouldn't hold water on this day.

Picking stones with the grand anticipation of picking the last was a rhythmical journey. For the first time, I was about to overcome Greg. However, towards the end, eight stones were left, and Greg picked three, leaving five. With great remorse, I picked four stones, leaving Greg to become the victor.

Greg had unsurprisingly outsmarted me once again. However, the real value of the video game was the insight. I noticed that Greg waited for me to make a move, then responded with a calculated counter. Later I found out that it only worked because the number of stones was a multiple of five.

"Tony, have wit!" said Greg before I was thrust back into reality by Joshua, thinking I was asleep.

I answered the question, described the solution, and won the game. Joshua nodded in agreement, then chuckled before admitting that he didn't even know the answer beforehand.

The simple question posed by Joshua made me more curious about games, and in particular, game theory. Finding mathematical strategies to win at various games was an art and something that was well-established theoretically. I decided to spend my free time at school enriching my body of knowledge about games, making some of my own on the way.

The stark contrast between my school environment, where I could engage with video games over the weekends, and my home environment, where I had to make my own games with Joshua, prodded me to be more inventive and imaginative in my life. The skill of picturing concepts or ideas can be traced back to Joshua's challenge.

My experiences will prove vital in my journey through university mathematics and beyond, turning challenges into games.

Education progression

Details

Education progression details No change in progression

PREVIEW

Duke University questions

General

Undergraduate program	Arts & Sciences (Trinity)
Preferred start term	Fall 2024
Admission plan	Regular Decision
Financial aid	Yes
Alumni Interview Contact Desired	Yes, I can be contacted if an interview is available
ROTC Scholarship?	No
Please indicate if you are going to use one of the following fee waivers (you can choose other fee waiver options in the Common Application)	No - None of the above apply
Signature Opportunities	Bass Connections, Duke Gap Year Program, DukeEngage, DukeImmerse, Pratt Research Fellows
Portfolio	No
Duke Kunshan University	No
Testing Plan	I would like my SAT and/or ACT scores considered as part of the evaluation process
Religion	Anglican (Episcopal)

Academics

What academic major at Duke University interests you? (first choice):	Mathematics
What academic program at Duke University interests you? (second choice):	Physics
What academic program at Duke University interests you? (third choice):	Engineering: Energy

Contacts

Previously applied	No
Contact 1	Attended a virtual or in-person college fair
Contact 2	College Search Website(s) [BigFuture, Better Make Room and others]
Contact 3	School Counselor
If you wish to be contacted via mobile phone, please provide your phone number. Contact methods may include phone calls generated from an automated telephone dialing system or text messaging.	I consent to be contacted by Duke University at the mobile phone number provided below.
Mobile Phone Number:	+254.713466762

Family

Parent 1 Relationship	Mother
Parent 1 First / Given name*	Jebet
Parent 1 Middle initial	C
Parent 1 Last/Family/Surname	Odhiambo
Parent 1 Maiden / Other last name	Chebii
Parent 1 Country of birth	Kenya
Parent 1 Employment position / title	Human Resources Manager
Have they ever attended Duke University?	No
Are they a current, full-time employee of Duke University/Duke Health System?	No
Parent 2 Relationship	Father
Parent 2 First / Given name	Christopher
Parent 2 Middle initial	O

Parent 2 Last/Family/Surname	Mak'Anyango
Parent 2 country of birth	Kenya
Parent 2 Employment Position / Title	Horticulture Farmer
Parent 2 Duke Alum	No
Parent 2 Duke Employee	No
Do you have a step-parent to list?	No
Do you live with a guardian?	No
Parent different address	No
Do you have a grandparent that attended Duke?	No
Do you have any siblings to list?	Yes
Sibling 1 relationship	Brother
Sibling 1 First/Given Name	Arnold
Sibling 1 Last/Family/Surname	Odhiambo
Sibling 1 Age	20
Sibling 1 Education level	Some college/university
Sibling 1 Duke Attendance	None
Sibling 1 College Attending	Strathmore University
Sibling 1 Degree earned or expected	Bachelor's (BA, BS)
Sibling 1 College start date	05/01/2021
Sibling 1 College end date	05/14/2025
Do you have another sibling to list?	Yes
Sibling 2 Relationship	Sister
Sibling 2 First/Given Name	Sharon

Sibling 2 Last/Family/Surname	Odhiambo
Sibling 2 Age	11
Sibling 2 Education level	Some grade/primary school
Sibling 2 Duke Attendance	None
Do you have another sibling to list?	Yes
Sibling 3 Relationship	Sister
Sibling 3 First/Given Name	Abigail
Sibling 3 Last/Family/Surname	Odhiambo
Sibling 3 Age	1
Sibling 3 Education level	None
Sibling 3 Duke Attendance	None
Do you have another sibling to list?	No

Other Information

Duke Community Standard	Yes
Duke Conditions of Application	Yes

Disciplinary Information

School discipline	No
Military discharge Y/N	No
Criminal History	No

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here: <http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.